BBC LEARNING ENGLISH

Real Easy English
The cinema

This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.



Georgie
Hi Phil.

Phil
Hi Georgie. How's your week going?

Georgie
It's going very well, thank you. I watched a really good **film** last night.

Phil
Did you watch it at home or at the cinema?

Georgie
I watched it at home on my sofa with my housemates.

Phil
Oh, was it good?

Georgie
It was very good. Now, I told you I watched a **film** last night at home, but in this episode of Real Easy English, we're talking about cinema. So, the cinema is where you watch **films**, or in American English they're sometimes called **movies**.

Phil
And before we get started, let's just remind everyone that if you go to bbclearningenglish.com, there's a worksheet where you can practise all the language that you'll hear in this episode.

Georgie
So, Phil, do you go to the cinema often?

Phil
No. No, I don't go very often at all. What about you?

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Georgie
I don't go often, but I did go a couple of weeks ago. I went to see an action **film**, a recent action **film**, and it was really **spectacular**. And I'm not a big fan of action **movies** – action **films**. I prefer **films** that are a bit less stressful, so I wouldn't usually watch action **films** at home, but in the cinema it was really an amazing experience because you have the big screen. You have amazing sound. And I really enjoyed it!

Phil
I've not actually been to the cinema for maybe two years, I think.

Georgie
Wow, Phil! Why don't you go to the cinema? Do you not like it?

Phil
I like... I like the cinema as an event, so the last time I went, I went with my kids. I can't remember what **film**, but it was a big thing for them to go and they were excited about it, but I don't know... I like the big screen. I like the sound. I like the event. But if you want to spend time with people, I think in a cinema you can't talk to anyone. You sit in the dark. You can't talk. And it's not the best when you want to talk to people, when you want to get to know people, so I tend to watch **films** more at home, to be honest.

Georgie
Yeah, but what about if you go to the cinema with people that you see very often and you don't need to catch up or find out about their lives? You're just going to watch a **film** and to relax.

Phil
Yeah. I mean, yeah, that makes sense because it is... it is nice to get out. It is nice to get out of the house and see it on a big screen.

Georgie
There are also other downsides to going to the cinema. My big thing with the cinema is that the seats are not very comfortable. It's much more comfortable to watch a **film** at home because you might have a sofa, blankets – you can lie down. You don't have to sit like we are now in a chair upright. Yeah, it's really nice at home. You have your snacks. You don't have to pay for them as well.

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Phil
I also think TVs that people have at home now are much better than they used to be. When I was a kid, you had a tiny little TV and it was so different to watching something at the cinema. But now I've got quite a nice telly.

Georgie
So, Phil, you talked about going to the cinema as, like, an event. So, something we do for special occasions. I really feel that. I love going to the cinema because you can buy snacks that you wouldn't normally eat. Like, **popcorn** is something I don't eat at home, but I eat at the cinema. And then going in a little bit early and watching the **film trailers**, which are short adverts for **films** that are coming up soon that are shown at the cinema. Is there anything else you like about the cinema?

Phil
What is nice about the cinema is that you can have no **distractions**. You just have the **film**. You put your phone away. At least you should put your phone away! Some people... some people in the cinema don't follow the rules, but hopefully everyone watching puts their phone away. There's no **distractions**. You can just relax and get involved in the **film**.

Georgie
It's really nice. It is really annoying when people in front of you or next to you are talking really loudly throughout the **film**. It's OK to whisper. So, that's when you whisper like that. It's OK to do that every now and again, but if they're talking all the way through the **film**, that is really annoying.

Phil
Yeah, I can't stand that.

Georgie
Phil, what kind of **films** do you like to watch at the cinema?

Phil
I think a **film** that takes you to a different place. So, something that's quite **spectacular** – there's a lot happening. There's a lot to see. Or maybe a **film** that shows you a bit of the world that's interesting that you don't know that well. I kind of like **films** like that – **films** that take you somewhere, that show you something you wouldn't normally see. That's definitely good to watch on a big screen.

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Georgie
Yeah, I agree. I wouldn't go to the cinema to watch a romantic comedy, a romcom. I agree with you. I'd like to watch something, yeah, **spectacular**. OK. Phil, it's time to look at some of the vocabulary we heard in this conversation, starting with **trailers**, which are short adverts for new **films** shown at the cinema.

Phil
And we also talked about **popcorn**. Now, **popcorn** – it's a snack. It's made of corn, and it's usually either sweet or salty, and it's very nice and you get it at the cinema.

Georgie
We also heard **spectacular**, which is a very strong adjective to describe something that is very exciting to look at.

Phil
And we talked about **distractions**. Things that are **distractions** are things that make you look at something you might not have wanted to look at, like someone's phone screen instead of the **film**.

Georgie
And the things that you watch in the cinema are called **films**, or sometimes called **movies** as well.

Phil
OK. And that's it for this week's episode of Real Easy English, but don't worry – we'll be back next week with another episode in easy English.

Georgie
And don't forget to download a free worksheet to test what you've learned at bbclearningenglish.com. Goodbye for now.

Phil
Bye!

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